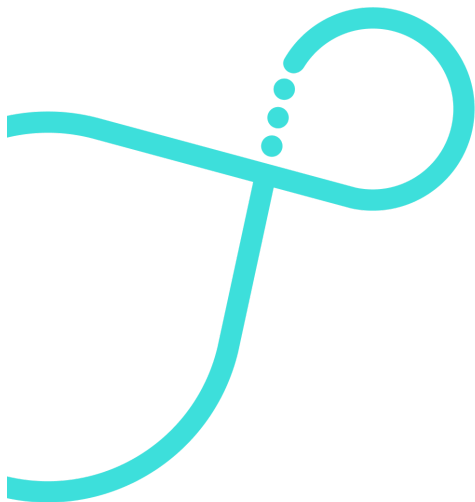




PEOPLE OPERATIONS · REFERENCE

Pay, Hours and Breaks

Bill rates, overtime and double time, what counts as work time, and the meal and rest rules in each state we operate in.



Pay, Hours and Breaks

Revised March 2026

Audience

Hiring managers, HR and Finance

Classification

Internal use only

Pay and Bill Rates

The bill rate is what we pay the agency per hour for a contingent worker. It is not what the worker takes home — the agency's employment costs, taxes, benefits and margin all come out of it. A bill rate roughly 1.4 to 1.6 times the equivalent hourly wage is normal, and it is not a markup to be negotiated away; it is the cost of someone else carrying the employment relationship.

Who sets it. HR agrees rates with our agencies and reviews them annually against the market. Rates are set per role, not per person, so two people doing the same job come in at the same rate.

Managers do not negotiate rates. Not with the agency, not with the worker. If a rate looks wrong for the market, or an agency pushes back on a role, tell HR — they will look at it. Agreeing something directly undercuts every other assignment we have and damages a relationship we depend on.

Rate changes mid-assignment are unusual. They happen where the role has genuinely changed, or at the annual review for a long-running assignment. They go through HR and need the same approval as an extension.

Contractor pricing works differently: a fixed fee or milestone payments agreed in the SOW, or capped time and materials where the work genuinely cannot be scoped. See Contract and Statement of Work.

What the worker earns is between them and their employer. If a contingent worker tells you they are unhappy with their pay, or asks what we are paying the agency:

- do not tell them the bill rate
- do not offer an opinion on whether their pay is fair
- point them to their agency contact
- tell HR if it sounds like something is genuinely wrong

That last point matters. Occasionally a worker raises something that is a real problem — being paid below the agreed rate, or not being paid at all. Do not investigate it, but do pass it to HR the same day.

Budgeting. Beeline shows committed and actual spend per assignment. A rough planning figure: a contingent worker at \$60/hour bill rate, full time, costs about \$10,400 a month. Check Assignment Spend before extending anyone.

Overtime, Double Time and Comp Time

These rules apply to contingent workers, who are paid hourly. Contractors are paid against a SOW and none of this applies to them.

Overtime. Anything over 40 hours in a week is paid at 1.5 times the regular rate. This is federal law under the FLSA and it applies to us at any headcount.

Two of our states count overtime by the day as well:

State	Daily overtime	Double time
California	1.5× beyond 8 hours in a day, up to 12	2× beyond 12 hours in a day, and beyond 8 hours on the seventh consecutive day worked in a week
Colorado	1.5× beyond 12 hours in a day	—
Illinois	Weekly only	—
Texas	Weekly only	—

So a worker in California doing four 10-hour days is owed overtime for 8 hours, even though the week totals 40. A worker in Texas doing the same is not. Beeline applies the right rule from the worker's recorded state, which is why keeping their location accurate matters.

Overtime must be agreed in advance. Not because it is optional to pay — it is not, once worked — but because it is your budget and you should know. If overtime appears on a timesheet you did not approve, reject it and talk to the worker and the agency.

Double time on holidays. Where a contingent worker is asked to work on one of our recognised holidays, the assignment can provide for double time. This is agreed in advance with HR and the agency, not decided in the moment.

Compensatory time is not allowed. You cannot give a contingent worker time off next week instead of paying this week's overtime. It is unlawful for non-exempt workers in the private sector, and it is one of the easiest things for a regulator to find. Every hour worked goes on the timesheet, under the right code, and is paid in the week it was worked.

Exempt workers. A small number of contingent assignments are for exempt roles, where the agency bills a flat 40-hour week regardless of hours worked. The agency determines exempt status, not us, and HR will tell you before the assignment starts if it applies.

What Counts as Work Time

Work time is any time a worker spends on something that benefits us or that we require — whether or not anyone asked them to do it, and whether or not it happens at their desk.

This matters because every hour of work time must be paid, at no less than minimum wage, with overtime where it applies. The agency is responsible for paying it, but we are the ones creating the hours, so the way we manage people determines the bill.

Counts as work time

- the obvious: doing the job
- required training, and required meetings
- travel between work sites during the day
- short breaks of 20 minutes or less — always paid, never deducted
- being on site and required to be available, even if it is quiet

- work done outside normal hours because we asked for it, including answering messages in the evening

Does not count

- commuting from home to their normal place of work
- a genuine meal break of 30 minutes or more where they are completely free of duties
- time entirely their own, with no expectation of availability

The trap. "Just check your email before you log on" and "stay by the phone in case" are both work time. If you expect availability, you are buying hours. Be explicit with contingent workers about when they are and are not working — vagueness here is how unpaid work happens, and it is the worker who pays for it.

Short breaks are paid. A ten-minute break, a coffee, a step outside — paid, and not deducted from anything. This is federal law, not a courtesy.

Meal breaks can be unpaid, but only if all of these are true: the break is at least 30 minutes; the worker is completely relieved of duties, which means not eating at their desk while covering the queue; and they are generally free to leave. Eating while nominally on call does not qualify — that is a paid break.

If a break is interrupted, it becomes work time and the worker should record it. Tell them that explicitly, because most people will not.

Anything under 30 minutes that you are thinking of treating as an unpaid break is not one. Ask HR before you do.

Meal and Rest Breaks by State

We currently have people in **California, Colorado, Illinois and Texas**. State rules apply based on where the worker physically does the work, not where we are based — so a remote worker in California gets California's rules.

	California	Colorado	Illinois	Texas
Meal break	30 min, unpaid, starting before the end of hour 5. A second 30 min before the end of hour 10 on shifts over 10 hours — waivable if the shift finishes within 12	30 min, unpaid, on shifts over 5 hours. Not in the first or last hour where practical	20 min, unpaid, on shifts of 7½ hours or more, taken before the end of hour 5. Another 20 min for each further 4½ hours	No state requirement
Rest breaks	Paid 10 min for every 4 hours, or major fraction. Roughly the middle of each block	Paid 10 min for every 4 hours. 1 break on shifts over 2 up to 6 hours, 2 up to 10 hours, 3 up to 14 hours	No state requirement	No state requirement
Weekly rest	—	—	24 consecutive hours off in every 7 days	—

	California	Colorado	Illinois	Texas
Missed break penalty	1 hour's pay per day for a missed meal, and another for a missed rest break	10 minutes' pay per missed rest break	—	—

Texas and the federal baseline. Texas has no state meal or rest law. Federal rules still apply: short breaks of 20 minutes or less are paid, and a meal break can only be unpaid if it meets the conditions in What Counts as Work Time.

California is the one to watch. The penalties are per day and they add up quickly — a worker who misses both a meal and a rest break is owed two extra hours of pay for that day. The common cause is a well-meant "just push through lunch, we're slammed". Do not do it, and make sure whoever covers for you knows not to either.

Practical rules for managers

- Build breaks into the shift. Do not rely on people taking them.
- Never ask someone to skip or shorten a break. Never imply it.
- If a break gets interrupted, tell them to record it as work time.
- Cover matters: if there is nobody to hand over to, the break will not happen.

Any other state. If we place someone anywhere outside these four, the rules will be different. Tell HR before the assignment starts — do not assume the nearest state's rules apply, and do not assume the federal baseline is enough.